

BRAM
THORNVALE

Level 3 Half-Orc Ranger (Fey Wanderer)

DM

QUICK SHEET

"Family heirloom. Technically not meant for me. But they seem to disagree."

PLAYER Chris		BACKGROUND Noble		ALIGNMENT Chaotic Good		XP 927
AGE 25		SIZE / HEIGHT Medium / 6 ft 4 in		SPEED 30 ft		RULES Legacy 2014 5e*
STR 14 (+2)	DEX 16 (+3)	CON 14 (+2)	INT 8 (-1)	WIS 14 (+2)	CHA 10 (+0)	
ARMOR CLASS 15 Studded leather		MAX HP 28 Current: ____		INITIATIVE +3 Advantage	PROF. BONUS +2 Level 3	PASSIVE PERCEPTION 14 Insight 12 / Invest. 9

Attacks and Damage

ATTACK	TO HIT	DAMAGE	RANGE / PROPERTY	SPECIAL
Thornwake - main sai	+5	1d6 + 3 piercing	Melee; finesse/light	Dreadful Strikes +1d4 once/turn
Briarbite - off-hand sai	+5	1d6 + 3 piercing	Melee; finesse/light	Bonus action; TWF adds Dex
Longbow	+5	1d8 + 3 piercing	150 / 600 ft; two-handed	Favored Foe can apply once/turn

TURN PLAN 1. Move into range. 2. Attack with Thornwake at +5. 3. Bonus Action: attack with Briarbite at +5. 4. On a hit, add Dreadful Strikes +1d4 once per turn. If a big enemy: use Favored Foe.	KEY RESOURCES Spell slots: [] [] [] Favored Foe: [] [] Hit Dice: [] [] [] (d10) Death Saves: Success [] [] [] Failure [] [] [] Inspiration: [] Attunement: Weapon of Warning (1 of 3)
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Weapon of Warning Sais - Attuned Paired iron sais named Thornwake and Briarbite. Advantage on initiative. Bram and allies within 30 ft cannot be surprised unless incapacitated. The sais can magically warn and wake the group when danger begins. No +1 bonus unless the DM adds one.

*Final ability scores, studded leather, paired sais, and Weapon of Warning are treated as DM-approved for this rule-of-cool one-shot.

STATISTICS AND SKILLS

Complete numerical reference

Saving Throws and Senses

SAVE	BONUS	PROFICIENCY
Strength	+4	Yes
Dexterity	+5	Yes
Constitution	+2	-
Intelligence	-1	-
Wisdom	+2	-
Charisma	+0	-

Senses
Passive Perception: 14
Passive Insight: 12
Passive Investigation: 9
Vision: Darkvision 60 ft (Half-Orc).

All Skills

SKILL	ABILITY	BONUS	TRAINING / NOTE
Acrobatics	DEX	+3	-
Animal Handling	WIS	+2	-
Arcana	INT	-1	-
Athletics	STR	+4	Proficient
Deception	CHA	+0 / +2	Otherworldly Glamour
History	INT	+1	Proficient
Insight	WIS	+2	-
Intimidation	CHA	+2 / +4	Proficient + Glamour
Investigation	INT	-1	-
Medicine	WIS	+2	-
Nature	INT	-1	-
Perception	WIS	+4	Proficient
Performance	CHA	+0 / +2	Otherworldly Glamour
Persuasion	CHA	+2 / +4	Proficient + Glamour
Religion	INT	-1	-
Sleight of Hand	DEX	+3	-
Stealth	DEX	+3	-
Survival	WIS	+4	Proficient

PROFICIENCIES AND CLASS FEATURES

What Bram can do

Proficiencies

CATEGORY	DETAILS
Armor	Light armor, medium armor, shields
Weapons	Simple weapons and martial weapons
Tools	Gaming set (Dragonchess or similar noble game)
Languages	Common, Orc, Elvish
Saving Throws	Strength, Dexterity
Class/Background Skills	Athletics, History, Intimidation, Perception, Persuasion, Survival

Half-Orc Traits

- Darkvision.** Bram can see in dim light within 60 ft as bright light, and darkness as dim light.
- Menacing.** He is proficient in Intimidation.
- Relentless Endurance.** Once per long rest, when reduced to 0 HP but not killed outright, he drops to 1 HP instead.
- Savage Attacks.** On a melee weapon critical hit, roll one extra weapon damage die.

Ranger Features

- Favored Foe.** When Bram hits a creature, he can mark it and deal +1d4 damage once per turn to that target. Uses: 2 per long rest.
Tasha's version uses concentration.
- Fighting Style.** Two-Weapon Fighting. Bram adds his Dexterity modifier to off-hand weapon damage.
- Exploration Training.** Use the DM's selected 2014/Tasha's ranger exploration rules for travel, tracking, and wilderness knowledge.

Fey Wanderer Features

- Dreadful Strikes.** Once per turn when Bram hits with a weapon attack, the target takes +1d4 psychic damage.
- Otherworldly Glamour.** Bram adds his Wisdom modifier (+2) to Charisma checks. This is why he can be charming with CHA 10.
- Fey Wanderer Magic.** Charm Person is always available from the subclass.

Table Reminder

Bram is not a full tank and does not have Extra Attack at level 3. His reliable turn is: move in, attack with one sai, bonus-action off-hand attack, then add Dreadful Strikes once if a hit lands.

RANGER SPELLBOOK

Spell slots and quick casting rules

SPELLCASTING	SAVE DC	ATTACK BONUS	SLOTS	KNOWN/PREPARED
Wisdom	12	+4	3 first-level	4 spells total

Spell Slot Tracker

First-level slots: [] [] []

Concentration: Only one concentration effect can usually be active at a time. Favored Foe, Ensnaring Strike, and Fog Cloud can conflict.

Cure Wounds

CASTING TIME	RANGE	DURATION	COMPONENTS	USE
1 action	Touch	Instantaneous	V, S	Heal 1d8 + 2 HP.

Ensnaring Strike

CASTING TIME	RANGE	DURATION	COMPONENTS	USE
Bonus action	Self	Concentration, up to 1 min	V	Next hit can restrain.

Fog Cloud

CASTING TIME	RANGE	DURATION	COMPONENTS	USE
1 action	120 ft	Concentration, up to 1 hour	V, S	20-ft-radius heavy mist.

Charm Person

CASTING TIME	RANGE	DURATION	COMPONENTS	USE
1 action	30 ft	1 hour	V, S	Humanoid Wis save DC 12.

FIRST-LEVEL SPELLS

Practical limits and table use

Cure Wounds

Action, touch, instantaneous. Bram touches a creature and heals 1d8 + Wisdom modifier (1d8+2). This is an emergency fix, not his main job.

Ensnaring Strike

Bonus action, concentration. The next time Bram hits with a weapon attack before the spell ends, the target must save or become restrained by thorny/fey vines. Important: using this consumes the same bonus action he usually uses for his off-hand attack.

Fog Cloud

Action, concentration. Creates a 20-foot-radius cloud of heavy obscuring mist. Strong for retreat, cover, splitting enemies, or hiding movement. It can also block allied vision, so use with care.

Charm Person

Action, 30 ft, Wisdom save DC 12. The target knows it was charmed after the spell ends. It works best for roleplay, de-escalation, or getting a small opening - not as a replacement for good judgment.

Rule-of-Cool Spell Prompts

Ensnaring Strike: thorny iron-brambles, spectral roots, fae vines around an ankle.

Fog Cloud: Briarwatch mist rolling from nowhere, pale green-white fog, a border-wood haze.

Charm Person: a warm smile, old court manners, a fae-touched sense that Bram is easier to trust than he should be.

Cure Wounds: old household remedies, ranger field care, and a flicker of strange green life in the wound.

Bonus-Action Conflict

Bram usually uses his bonus action for the off-hand sai attack. If he casts Ensnaring Strike, he normally cannot also make the off-hand attack that same turn.

MAGIC ITEM AND THORNVALE SAIS

Special item and heirloom stat block

Weapon of Warning - Thornwake and Briarbite

CATEGORY	DETAILS
Category	Weapon, uncommon; requires attunement
Attunement	Yes - Bram is attuned (1 of 3 possible items). The paired sais count as one magic item by DM approval.
Mechanical Form	Two iron sais using shortsword stats: finesse, light, melee, 1d6 piercing.
Warning Magic	Advantage on initiative. Bram and companions within 30 ft cannot be surprised unless incapacitated.
Sleeping Companions	If combat begins while sleeping, the magic can awaken Bram and companions within range.
Important Limit	No +1 to attack or damage unless the DM specifically grants it.

In-World Sensory Warnings

- a low hum before danger,
- a cold ache in the hand,
- a faint metallic ringing,
- a pulse through the grip,
- a prickling sense of being watched,
- a subtle pull toward or away from danger.

Thornvale Heirloom Meaning

The iron is deliberate. In Thornvale tradition, iron means protection, boundary, warning, and defiance. The sais may be more than weapons: keys, seals, symbols of authority, or tools used by past Wardens of the Briarwatch threshold. Bram acts casual about them, but they are proof that something chose him. That frightens him. It also means everything to him.

Table Reminder

At level 3, Bram has one action and one bonus action. Thornwake is the action attack. Briarbite is the bonus-action off-hand attack. Dreadful Strikes can add +1d4 psychic once per turn when a weapon hit lands.

INVENTORY, PACK AND WEALTH

Tracked equipment and coin

Weapons, Armor and Adventuring Gear

ITEM	QTY.	NOTES
Studded leather armor	1	AC 12 + Dexterity modifier = 15
Thornwake - warning sai	1	Main hand; shortsword stats; paired magic item
Briarbite - warning sai	1	Off-hand; shortsword stats; paired magic item
Longbow	1	Primary ranged option
Arrows	20	Carried in quiver
Fine clothes	1 set	Noble background
Signet ring	1	House Thornvale of Briarwatch
Scroll of pedigree	1	Proof of noble lineage
Purse	1	Contains coin and small valuables
Gaming set	1 set	Dragonchess or similar noble game
Traveler/adventuring gear	As approved	Ranger travel supplies, rations, waterskin, bedroll, etc.

Suggested Pack

Backpack	Bedroll	Mess kit	Tinderbox
10 torches	10 days rations	Waterskin	50 ft hempen rope
Hunting/travel kit	Briarwatch keepsakes	Iron charms	Small knife/tools

WEALTH / CAPACITY	CURRENT
CP	60
SP	67
EP	0
GP	20
PP	0
Gems	4 gems worth 10 gp each
Carrying capacity	210 lb max; 420 lb push/drag/lift

*Coin and gems follow the prior Fast Character treasure; DM may adjust for the one-shot.

BACKGROUND AND ROLEPLAYING

Noble identity, appearance and personality

Noble Background

Feature - Position of Privilege. People are inclined to think the best of Bram because of his noble birth; he can secure audiences, hospitality, or recognition when appropriate.

House Title. House Thornvale is best framed as Wardens of Briarwatch: minor border nobility with old duties near the fae woods, not royalty.

Public Role. The family protects the old border and maintains customs that keep the fae woods from becoming everyone's problem.

Appearance and Manner

DETAIL	CURRENT ANSWER
Hair	Thick dark, slightly messy
Eyes	Warm, expressive
Skin	Green/olive half-orc complexion
Build	6 ft 4 in, 245 lb, broad, strong, sturdy, surprisingly graceful
Dress	Open-neck shirt, worn leather, green/brown ranger-noble clothes, good boots, signet ring
First impression	Handsome, flirty, dangerous until he smiles - then mostly trouble
Actual manner	Warm, playful, protective, observant, and better educated than he pretends

Personality

Traits. I charge into things with complete confidence, even when I only understand half of what is happening. I flirt when I'm nervous, happy, confused, threatened, or awake.

Ideal. Freedom. Good people should be protected from cruel people, old curses, and anyone who abuses power.

Bond. My family guards the fae-touched estate of Briarwatch.

Flaw. I mistake confidence for a plan and charm for permission.

Important Tone. Flirty, not creepy. Goofy, not useless. Underestimated by choice as much as by habit.

BACKSTORY PACKET

Snapshot, house title, and core idea

One-Sentence DM Hook

Bram Thornvale is the overlooked younger son of a fae-border noble house, raised more by servants than family, carrying heirloom warning-sais that were meant for his favored sister but awakened for him, marking him as the possible true inheritor of a hidden Thornvale fae pact he does not yet understand.

Character Snapshot

DETAIL	ANSWER
Name	Bram Thornvale of Briarwatch
Race/Class	Half-Orc Ranger 3 - Fey Wanderer
Background	Noble
Magic Item	Paired iron sais functioning as a Weapon of Warning
Family	House Thornvale of Briarwatch
Suggested Title	Wardens of Briarwatch / Warden of Briarwatch
Homeland	A small, old border realm beside the fae woods

Core Idea

Bram is the younger child of House Thornvale. His older sister was the favored child, the intended heir, and the one prepared to inherit the family duties and heirloom weapons. Bram was technically noble, but often treated like an afterthought in his own home. He jokes about it, downplays it, and acts like it was normal. It was not normal.

The paired iron sais he now carries were never meant for him. They were meant for his older sister. But when the old Thornvale legacy stirred, the weapons did not answer her. They answered Bram. Bram believes he is the overlooked son who accidentally inherited something meant for someone better. The truth may be that the old woods chose him first.

BACKSTORY PACKET

House Thornvale and Briarwatch

House Thornvale

House Thornvale of Briarwatch is old, respected, and strange. Their territory is not huge; they are not rulers of a great empire. They are an old noble house tied to a specific place, a specific duty, and a specific border: the edge of the fae woods. Their working title is Warden of Briarwatch, marking them as protectors, diplomats, and keepers of old customs at the dangerous threshold between mortal lands and fae woods.

Publicly, House Thornvale protects the border from the dangers of the old fae woods. Privately, the family may have a much deeper connection to the fae than Bram knows. They may not only guard the realm from the woods; they may also guard the realm from what the family owes the woods.

Briarwatch Estate

Briarwatch is the Thornvale ancestral estate and the center of their small border realm. It sits close enough to the old woods that mist curls across the grounds unnaturally, strange lights can be seen between trees, and old paths seem to shift when no one is watching.

The estate should feel like old noble manor, border fortress, witchy cottage, forgotten fae residence, and lived-in family home all at once. It has dark weathered stone, climbing ivy, moss, steep roofs, stained glass, wrought iron, hidden courtyards, crooked garden walls, herb gardens, servant passages, and old charms tucked into doorways and windowsills. Bram's warmest memories are from kitchens, gardens, stables, servant passages, and the edges of the woods - not the formal halls.

DM-Usable Estate Details

Formal gardens grow wilder near the woods. Bram knows servant passages better than noble halls. A neglected training yard is where he learned the sais. A boundary wall may be marked with iron charms, thorns, runes, or offerings. There is likely a forbidden path into the fae woods that everyone avoids.

FULL BACKSTORY

Part I - Childhood and family position

Bram was born the younger child of House Thornvale. His older sister was everything his parents wanted in an heir: polished, intelligent, graceful, disciplined, well-spoken, and prepared for leadership. Bram was different: broad, warm, physical, impulsive, funny, affectionate, and more comfortable with stablehands, cooks, nannies, hunters, and border wardens than with formal tutors or noble guests.

His parents did not usually treat him with open cruelty. They rarely screamed. They rarely struck him. They rarely said directly that they wished he had been different. Instead, they overlooked him. They left him behind on family trips, brought his sister to councils and ceremonies, praised her and corrected him, gave her purpose and gave him errands, introduced her as the future of House Thornvale, and treated Bram like an afterthought.

Bram was still educated as a noble. He knows etiquette, heraldry, family history, border customs, formal introductions, and how to behave in noble spaces. But he was not loved like an heir. He was managed like an inconvenience. He does not usually call this neglect. He jokes about it, downplays it, and acts like it was just how things were.

What This Means at the Table

Bram is not stupid. He has learned that being underestimated is useful. He can survive a formal dinner, read a family crest, recognize a political insult, and speak noble etiquette when needed. He acts like a pretty fool because it gives him room to breathe and lets careless people reveal more than they should.

Core Wound

Bram was not chosen for trips, lessons that mattered, family pride, inheritance, affection, or legacy. Then the sais chose him. That should have felt like triumph. Instead, it terrified him.

FULL BACKSTORY

Part II - Sister, parents, and the broken inheritance

Bram's older sister was the intended heir of House Thornvale. She was meant to inherit the estate, the title, the family duties, and the paired iron sais. She may have loved Bram, but she was also the center of their parents' hopes. She was shaped into the perfect heir and may not have fully understood how differently Bram was treated. In some ways, both siblings were harmed: Bram was ignored, and his sister was controlled.

When the time came to inherit the old Thornvale legacy, everything fell apart. Despite a lifetime of preparation, the paired iron sais and the ancient magic tied to House Thornvale did not answer her. Instead, they chose Bram. The revelation shattered the future she had spent her entire life working toward. Soon after, something went wrong involving the old fae woods, a family rite, or the hidden Thornvale legacy. She vanished, was taken, became trapped, was changed, or was otherwise lost. Her exact fate is open for the DM.

Bram's parents are not cartoon villains. They are colder than that: traditional, image-conscious, politically careful, emotionally distant, and deeply invested in the future of House Thornvale. After his sister disappeared and the sais chose Bram, he became a living reminder that the child they prepared was gone and the child they overlooked had been chosen instead.

Suggested Names

Recommended sister names: Elowen Thornvale or Isolde Thornvale. Other options: Seraphine, Maerwynn, Rosalind, Vespera.

Recommended parents: Aldren Thornvale and Morwen Thornvale. These names are optional and can change to fit the DM's setting.

How Bram Talks About It

"She was the proper Thornvale. I was mostly decorative." "Long story. Needs wine." "I wasn't unwanted. I was just... inconvenient." He usually avoids direct answers about his parents, sister, and why he left.

FULL BACKSTORY

Part III - The staff and the old woods

The household staff were Bram's real family. His nannies, cooks, stablehands, gardeners, guards, tutors, hunters, and old border wardens gave him the warmth his parents did not. From them, Bram learned practical skills: tracking, riding, fighting, listening, reading people, moving through servant passages, surviving near the woods, and respecting old fae warnings. This is why Bram is both noble and practical.

He can attend a formal dinner and recognize a noble insult, but he is more comfortable eating in the kitchen than sitting at the high table. He trusts workers, outsiders, animals, wanderers, cooks, old women with knives, and servants faster than he trusts nobles. Some staff may know or suspect more about his fae connection than they ever told him. They may have protected him quietly, taught him old warnings disguised as chores, or kept him away from certain family rituals.

The old fae woods are not just a forest. They are a threshold. Paths shift. Names matter. Promises bind. Music carries too far. Animals watch too closely. Strangers appear where no road should be. A person can leave for an hour and return three days later, or leave for three days and return before supper.

Fae Rules Bram Knows

Do not give your full name carelessly. Do not accept unknown gifts. Do not make promises lightly. Do not follow music into the trees. Do not assume beauty means kindness. Do not assume cruelty means evil. Always respect thresholds.

Important NPC Seeds

Old Nanny: songs that are actually warnings. The Cook: sharp-tongued and loving. Stablemaster: patience, riding, animal care. Border Warden / Armsmaster: taught Bram to fight and survive near the woods.

FULL BACKSTORY Part IV - The warning-sais and leaving home

Bram carries a matched pair of iron sais, heirloom weapons of House Thornvale. They are old, elegant, practical, and unusual for a noble house. Their iron is deliberate: in Thornvale tradition, iron means protection, boundary, warning, and defiance. The sais were supposed to pass to his older sister, but they answered Bram. Mechanically, they function as his Weapon of Warning. In-world, their warning may feel like a low hum before danger, a cold ache in the hand, a faint metallic ringing, a pulse through the grip, or a prickling sense of being watched.

The sais may be more than weapons. They may also be keys, seals, symbols of authority, or tools used by past wardens of the fae border. Bram acts casual about them, but he is deeply attached to them. They are proof that something chose him. That frightens him. It also means everything to him.

Bram did not leave because he hated Briarwatch. He loved the gardens, kitchens, stables, staff, old songs, hidden paths, and strange woods. But after his sister disappeared and the sais chose him, the estate became unbearable. His parents looked at him like a mistake. The court whispered. The old woods seemed to watch him more closely. Officially, he may have left as a ranger, scout, envoy, or border protector. Unofficially, he left because staying meant living every day as the wrong child holding the wrong inheritance.

Bram's View of Himself

He thinks he is fine. He is not fully fine. He learned that being charming was safer than being needy, that jokes could cover disappointment, that acting a little dumb made people underestimate him, and that if he smiled first no one would ask harder questions.

BACKSTORY SECRETS

Layers, DM truth, and future reveals

Secrets Organized by Layer

LAYER	MEANING
Layer 1: Public Knowledge	Bram is a charming younger son of House Thornvale, trained as a ranger near the old fae woods.
Layer 2: Private Emotional Truth	He was treated as lesser than his sister and hides it behind humor.
Layer 3: Family Shame	The sais were meant for his sister, not him. Their bond with Bram disrupted the family's expectations.
Layer 4: Hidden Family History	House Thornvale has a deeper connection to the fae than it publicly admits.
Layer 5: DM-Only Truth	Bram may be the true fae-marked heir, chosen warden, or inheritor of an ancient Thornvale pact.
Layer 6: Future Revelation	His sister, parents, or the fae woods may return to challenge what Bram believes about himself.

Suggested Best DM Version

Generations ago, House Thornvale made a bargain with a powerful fae entity of the old woods. In exchange for protection, land, and noble standing, the Thornvales agreed that one child of the bloodline in each marked generation would serve as warden of the threshold. The family believed Bram's older sister was the marked child because she was graceful, disciplined, and born to inherit. They were wrong. The old magic does not care about birth order, polish, or parental preference. The marked child was Bram.

DM Options

The DM can choose fae blood, an ancient Thorn Bargain, the Iron Wardens as a threshold-keeping order, or a failed rite where the woods took the wrong child. These options are hooks, not demands.

DM NOTES AND TABLE GUIDE

Hooks, tactics, party dynamics, and open questions

What Bram Is

A charming half-orc noble-ranger who learned to survive by being underestimated. A protective flirt with a quiet wound underneath. The overlooked child carrying heirloom sais that were never meant for him. A possible true Warden of Briarwatch whose family may be hiding the truth.

Roleplaying Cues

CUE	HOW BRAM ACTS
Default tone	Warm, flirtatious, lightly foolish, physically confident.
When comfortable	Teasing, affectionate, playful, protective.
When hurt	Jokes, flirts, deflects, acts dumb so no one sees the wound.
When friends are threatened	Stops joking; direct, dangerous, protective.
Authority trigger	Cruel nobles, cold families, people who treat others as lesser.
Moral line	He protects overlooked people; cruelty toward innocents is not funny.

Combat and Party Dynamics

Standard turn. Action attack with Thornwake, bonus-action off-hand attack with Briarbite, add Dreadful Strikes once per turn on a hit.

Tough target. Apply Favored Foe after a hit; remember concentration and once-per-turn timing.

Party synergy. Bram engages or distracts enemies while Medrick, Dan's Lightfoot Halfling Arcane Trickster, gets Sneak Attack opportunities.

The dwarf hermit druid brings nature magic, support, healing, and control.

No Extra Attack. At level 3, Bram attacks once with his action. The second sai is a bonus-action off-hand attack, not Extra Attack.

DM-Ready Hooks

- Someone from Briarwatch comes looking for Bram or the sais.
- The sais warn Bram of danger connected to his own family.
- A fae creature recognizes Bram by a title he does not know.
- Bram's sister returns changed, wounded, resentful, enchanted, or desperate.
- A member of the household staff contacts Bram for help.
- A childhood rhyme from his nanny turns out to be a warning, spell, map, or key.
- The sais open, seal, or reveal something tied to a fae threshold.
- The old fae bargain comes due.

Open Questions for the DM

What happened to Bram's sister? Did his parents know he was fae-marked? Are the Thornvales part fae, bound by bargain, or both? Are the sais only warning weapons, or also keys/seals tied to the old woods?